

Becoming a dom • Chapter 2

Art for your persona

Last checked 3 November 2026 • 10 minutes to read

A drawn persona needs art that you have the right to use. This chapter compares a paid artist, generated images and an existing character, and names the two lines that never move.

Verified | Vivian's field notes | Unverified

In 30 seconds

- There are three routes to a look: a paid artist, generated images, an existing character. Each trades cost, control and rights.
- Every persona is an adult in looks and setting, whatever the lore says. No platform and no rule of this wiki makes an exception.
- A real person's face or voice is never used without that person's consent. Several laws now treat sexual fakes of real adults as crimes.
- A studio's character belongs to the studio, and two publishers' own policies forbid earning money from their material.

- Check every image before it goes public, and settle credit in writing before art spreads.

You will learn

- What a paid artist, a generator and an existing character each allow and risk.
- How platforms treat drawn, generated and realistic adult art, as of 2026-11-03.
- Which laws cover sexual fakes of real people, in plain words.
- How to keep a look steady and check an image before it goes out.
- When making art for a persona is a fair gift and when it is free labour.

> Everything a sub knows about me is a picture, and every picture has a maker, a rule and a risk. I chose my look once and I guard it. Before you spend anything on art, know who made it, who may use it, and whether she is an adult.
>
> — **Vivian**

Three routes to a look

A persona needs a look before she needs an audience, and there are three ways to get one. A paid artist draws her. A generator produces her from a written description and reference images. Or she is built on a character that already exists. Most personas mix routes sooner or later, and each route trades cost, control and rights. ◑ The look itself goes into the persona file, as Build a persona explains.

Three routes compared

	Paid artist	Generated images	Existing character
Cost	Paid per piece, so it adds up	Tools, a plan or a strong graphics card	Cheapest to start
Control	The artist's hand and your brief	Yours, through text and reference images	Fixed by the studio
Steady look	Strong, with a model sheet	Hard without a recipe	Easy, the design exists
Rights	Settled if written down	Set by tool terms, ownership unsettled	Belong to the studio
Trust	Credit helps	Some followers dislike it	Shared with other personas

A paid artist. This is the slowest and costliest route, and the cleanest on rights when the agreement is written down. In my experience, posts that show a

human artist's work with credit tend to do better than generated art. That has never been measured, and audiences are split: some followers dislike generated art and others do not mind. Unverified

Before a paid artist starts

1. Say that the work is adult and for a persona, and get a clear yes before any sketch is made.
2. Fix the scope, the credit and the use: how many pieces, where the artist is named, and whether stickers, products or animation are included.
3. Ask whether the artist uses generated images in the work, and say whether you accept that.
4. Fix the payment, with dates and what happens if either side stops.
5. Write it in plain words that both of you can reread, and keep a copy.

That list names topics. It is not contract wording, and this wiki cannot supply wording for your country.

Generated images. This is the fastest route to start and the hardest to keep steady. Whether you may post or sell what a tool makes is set by that tool's terms, so read each one on adult and commercial use first. Whether a generated image can be owned at all differs by country, and as of 2026-11-03 this wiki found no source it can cite for that. Unverified The model matters too: Ko-fi bans AI models that were trained for prohibited adult content. Verified A community model of unknown origin is therefore part of your risk.

An existing character. Many personas are built on a character someone else drew, and the design then guides the whole look, from the colours of the horns or outfit to a habitual detail of clothing. It is the easiest route and the riskiest. The section on studios below says why.

The two lines that never move

Adults only

Every persona is an adult in her looks and in her setting, whatever the lore says. A birthday written in a biography changes nothing about a drawing, so "adult by lore" does not count, and a character who is a student, or who looks like one, is out. Platform rules name drawn and generated material, not only photographs.

- Throne bans any sexualised depiction of minors, including anime and manga characters meant to resemble minors. Verified
- Discord's rule covers fictional children and AI-generated images, and it names drawings, animation, text and the prompts used to make such content. Verified
- X names any depiction, generation or sexualization of a minor, and treats it as the highest severity. Verified

Check each image for child-like proportions, faces and settings, and discard what fails. Do not try to repair it. An adult character also says nothing about the audience, because a drawing cannot check anyone's age.

No real person without consent

Never use a real person's face or voice without that person's consent. This covers a photo used as a reference, a real name typed into a prompt, and a voice cloned from a performer, even when that voice speaks as a cartoon. Cloning a licensed

character's official voice for something you sell is also a rights risk, and this wiki does not call it standard practice.

- X prohibits content that sexualizes an identifiable real adult without explicit consent, and it names AI-generated and deepfake media. Verified
- X treats prompting or trying to generate such content as a violation, not only sharing it. Verified
- Discord lists AI-generated sexual imagery of real people among the non-consensual imagery it bans. Verified

This chapter is not legal advice. The laws below are summarised in plain words, so read the texts or ask a lawyer where you live.

What the laws say, as of 2026-11-03

United States

What it says

It is a federal crime to knowingly publish, on an online service, a digital forgery of an identifiable adult without consent. Verified

United States

What it says

Covered platforms must remove a reported image within 48 hours of a valid request. Verified

England and Wales

What it says

It is an offence to share an image that shows or appears to show a person in an intimate state without consent. Verified

England and Wales

What it says

Since 6 February 2026 it is also an offence to create such an image of another person without consent. Verified

These laws are written around a real person who is identified or who appears to be shown. A clearly invented character is another matter, but a lookalike of a real person is the case to avoid, and whether an image falls inside is a question for a lawyer. If someone makes a fake of you, the same rules work in your favour, and Discord offers a removal process where local law gives that right. Verified

A studio's character is the studio's

Using a famous character feels free because the tools already know her. She is not free: the studio owns the design. Publishers say in their own words what fans may do.

- Microsoft's game content rules say that an item made with its material cannot be sold or earn any compensation, including through ads, and cannot be pornographic or lewd. Verified
- Square Enix West says not to use its materials to make money or gain any other financial benefit, and it lists sexually explicit content among what not to make. Verified

Those two pages speak for two companies only. Other studios have other policies, so read the one that applies. A persona that sells content or earns from pages built on a studio's character is the case these policies forbid, and nobody has promised a tolerance to rely on.

The business risk follows. A character you do not own can leave your page the day her owner objects, and the account that carried her may go with her. She is also shared with other personas, so the look is never fully yours.

Vivian's field notes

If I were starting again, I would use a character of my own, even a rough one. A plain original look that I control beats a famous one that I only borrow. The look is the product, and a product on rented ground can be taken away overnight.

Keeping the look steady

A steady look is the hardest technical problem for a generated persona. The method that holds is short.

A recipe that keeps a look

1. Make a character sheet first: front, side and back views of one design, always an adult.
2. Write a fixed description: hair, eyes, ears or horns, build.
3. For each image, add a short paragraph for the outfit and scene, and give a reference image with the order to keep its exact design but ignore its pose and background.
4. Choose one tool and one recipe, because mixing sources breaks the look.
5. Keep the prompt of every image you like, because old prompts exist nowhere else.

A custom add-on model, called a LoRA, keeps a character identical in every pose, but it takes a long phase of bugs and tuning. Generated art also ages as models change, so many doms keep old-style and new-style images in separate folders.

Two habits keep you out of trouble. Private tests stay private. A tool that copies the pose of an existing illustration, or that fetches reference images by tag and copies their prompts, can slide into art theft once its output is posted. Nothing derived from a named artist's work should go public. Do not put a living artist's

name in a prompt either, because it borrows their style, so build the look on your own recipe.

Video costs more than stills. A failed attempt costs the same as a good one, and clips are made in short segments and joined, so many personas post a video only now and then. A persona also runs at a loss before it earns, so budget the tools against income you have and never finance them from a sub's sends in a way that pressures him. Strip hidden traces from every export, as Stay anonymous explains.

Check before you post

Fingers and toes
Count them. Extra or missing ones are the most common flaw.

Text in the picture
Look for stray words and marks baked into the image.

Proportions
Check the details that make her recognisable, and any horn or tail that should not be there.

Age
Any child-like face, body or setting means discard the image.

A real face
If she resembles someone real, discard it.

Fix or regenerate first, then show the fixed version, because a flawed image rarely survives a follower who knows the persona.

What platforms do with adult art

Platforms judge the picture and not your intention, and their rules change. Read each page yourself. Everything below is as of 2026-11-03.

- X allows consensual adult content that is properly labelled and not prominently displayed, and it applies this to AI-generated and animated content such as cartoons and anime. Verified
- X does not allow adult content in profile pictures, headers or live video. Verified
- Discord bars explicit content from avatars, bios and banners, and requires an age-restricted label on channels that carry it. Verified
- Throne applies its rules equally to real photos and to drawn, comic or anime-style art, and it does not allow explicit sexual acts in any format. Verified
- Patreon permits animated or illustrated AI-generated adult characters that follow its guidelines. Verified
- Patreon says it is not a place for sexual activity by or between real and hyperrealistic subjects. Verified

Mark real adult images with the sensitive media label yourself, and never try to fool a classifier. A realistic style changes which rules apply to you, as the last Patreon line shows.

On honesty, X's rule on fake personas names AI-generated profile photos used to deceive others, and X does not require a real identity on a profile. Verified A drawn character presented as a drawn character deceives nobody about what she is. A generated face presented as a real woman does.

Who owns what

When another person makes the art, that person may treat it as theirs and expect credit, while you treat it as the persona's body. Agree who owns and who is credited before the pictures spread. Borrowing another persona's art is fine with permission, and permission is what separates it from theft.

Subs sometimes make fan art or generated images of their dom as a tribute, and some doms assign image making to a sub as a task. A task is a fair gift of skill only when the sub chose the scope, can say no without losing his place, and is thanked. Otherwise it is free labour dressed as devotion. Throne says its wishlists cannot be used to exchange goods or services, including commissions. Verified It also bars profile text that offers content or services in exchange for gifts through Throne. Verified

Art tasks from the sub's chair

What they say or do

1 "Make me twenty images and I lift your restriction."

The counter

A reward that depends on his labour makes his skill the price. Ask what he gets back that he chose himself.

What they say or do

2 "If the picture is bad you have failed, and failure has a cost."

The counter

A penalty for effort turns a gift into a debt. Do not accept one.

What they say or do

3 "It is an honour to work for her, so no thanks are needed."

The counter

Honour is not pay. A fair task is thanked, and refusing it costs nothing.

A sub can offer art freely and still be used. Watch what happens when he says no.

Remember it

1. Three routes: a paid artist, generated images, an existing character. Each trades cost, control and rights.

2. Adults only, in looks and setting, with no exception for lore.

3. A real person’s face or voice needs that person’s consent, and sexual fakes of real adults are crimes in several countries.

4. A studio’s character belongs to the studio, and two publishers’ policies forbid earning money from their material.

5. Check every image before it goes out, and settle credit in writing before art spreads.

6. An art task is a gift only when the sub chose it and can refuse.

Check it

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

Evidence levels

Verified	Checked against the original source.

Reported	Stated by a serious secondary source read in full.
Community	Widely said in the scene; no document proves it.
Vivian's field notes	First-hand experience, not a study.
Unverified	Plausible, not proven yet.

1 Or she is built on a character that already exists.

Vivian's field notes

2 Most personas mix routes sooner or later, and each route trades cost, control and rights.

Vivian's field notes

3 This is the slowest and costliest route, and the cleanest on rights when the agreement is written down.

Vivian's field notes

4 In my experience, posts that show a human artist's work with credit tend to do better than generated art.

Vivian's field notes

5 That has never been measured, and audiences are split: some followers dislike generated art and others do not mind.

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6 This is the fastest route to start and the hardest to keep steady.

Vivian's field notes

7 Whether a generated image can be owned at all differs by country, and as of 2026-11-03 this wiki found no source it can cite for that.

Unverified

8 The model matters too: Ko-fi bans AI models that were trained for prohibited adult content.

Verified

Ko-fi Content Guidelines (https://help.ko-fi.com/hc/en-us/articles/360007937553)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20230927191131/https://help.ko-fi.com/hc/en-us/articles/360007937553)

Accessed 3 November 2026

9 A community model of unknown origin is therefore part of your risk.

Vivian's field notes

10 Many personas are built on a character someone else drew, and the design then guides the whole look, from the colours of the horns or outfit to a habitual detail of clothing.

Vivian's field notes

11 Every persona is an adult in her looks and in her setting, whatever the lore says.

Vivian's field notes

12 A birthday written in a biography changes nothing about a drawing, so “adult by lore” does not count, and a character who is a student, or who looks like one, is out.

Vivian’s field notes

13 Throne bans any sexualised depiction of minors, including anime and manga characters meant to resemble minors.

Verified

What’s allowed in my profile text and images? (https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15810290-what-s-allowed-in-my-profile-text-and-images)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261026034619/https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15810290-what-s-allowed-in-my-profile-text-and-images)

Accessed 3 November 2026

14 Discord’s rule covers fictional children and AI-generated images, and it names drawings, animation, text and the prompts used to make such content.

Verified

Discord Community Guidelines (rules 6, 9 and 10) (https://discord.com/guidelines)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261101163531/https://discord.com/guidelines)

Accessed 3 November 2026

15 X names any depiction, generation or sexualization of a minor, and treats it as the highest severity.

Verified

Non-Consensual Intimate Content policy (page title: Non-consensual nudity policy) (https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/intimate-media)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261014153519/https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/intimate-media)

Accessed 3 November 2026

16 Do not try to repair it.

Vivian's field notes

17 An adult character also says nothing about the audience, because a drawing cannot check anyone's age.

Vivian's field notes

18 Never use a real person's face or voice without that person's consent.

Vivian's field notes

19 This covers a photo used as a reference, a real name typed into a prompt, and a voice cloned from a performer, even when that voice speaks as a cartoon.

Vivian's field notes

20 Cloning a licensed character's official voice for something you sell is also a rights risk, and this wiki does not call it standard practice.

Vivian's field notes

21 X prohibits content that sexualizes an identifiable real adult without explicit consent, and it names AI-generated and deepfake media.

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Accessed 3 November 2026

22 X treats prompting or trying to generate such content as a violation, not only sharing it.

Verified

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Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261014153519/https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/intimate-media)

Accessed 3 November 2026

23 Discord lists AI-generated sexual imagery of real people among the non-consensual imagery it bans.

Verified

Non-Consensual Intimate Imagery Policy Explainer (https://discord.com/safety/non-consensual-intimate-media-policy-explainer)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261003140301/https://discord.com/safety/non-consensual-intimate-media-policy-explainer)

Accessed 3 November 2026

24 It is a federal crime to knowingly publish, on an online service, a digital forgery of an identifiable adult without consent.

Verified

Public Law 119-12, the TAKE IT DOWN Act (Tools to Address Known Exploitation by Immobilizing Technological Deepfakes on Websites and Networks Act) (https://www.congress.gov/119/plaws/publ12/PLAW-119publ12.htm)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20260826132235/https://www.congress.gov/119/plaws/publ12/PLAW-119publ12.htm)

Accessed 3 November 2026

25 Covered platforms must remove a reported image within 48 hours of a valid request.

Verified

Public Law 119-12, the TAKE IT DOWN Act (Tools to Address Known Exploitation by Immobilizing Technological Deepfakes on Websites and Networks Act) (https://www.congress.gov/119/plaws/publ12/PLAW-119publ12.htm)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20260826132235/https://www.congress.gov/119/plaws/publ12/PLAW-119publ12.htm)

Accessed 3 November 2026

26 It is an offence to share an image that shows or appears to show a person in an intimate state without consent.

Verified

Online Safety Act 2023, section 188: Sharing or threatening to share intimate photograph or film (inserts section 66B into the Sexual Offences Act 2003) (https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2023/50/section/188)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261019212114/https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2023/50/section/188)

Accessed 3 November 2026

27 Since 6 February 2026 it is also an offence to create such an image of another person without consent.

Verified

Data (Use and Access) Act 2025, section 138: Creating, or requesting the creation of, purported intimate image of adult (inserts section 66E into the Sexual Offences Act 2003) (https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2025/18/section/138)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261003002944/https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2025/18/section/138)

Accessed 3 November 2026

28 A clearly invented character is another matter, but a lookalike of a real person is the case to avoid, and whether an image falls inside is a question for a lawyer.

Vivian's field notes

29 If someone makes a fake of you, the same rules work in your favour, and Discord offers a removal process where local law gives that right.

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Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261003140301/https://discord.com/safety/non-consensual-intimate-media-policy-explainer)

Accessed 3 November 2026

30 She is not free: the studio owns the design.

Vivian's field notes

31 Microsoft's game content rules say that an item made with its material cannot be sold or earn any compensation, including through ads, and cannot be pornographic or lewd.

Verified

Game Content Usage Rules (https://www.xbox.com/en-US/developers/rules)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261021032024/https://www.xbox.com/en-US/developers/rules)

Accessed 3 November 2026

32 Square Enix West says not to use its materials to make money or gain any other financial benefit, and it lists sexually explicit content among what not to make.

Verified

Square Enix West Material Usage Policy (https://square-enix-games.com/documents/materialusagepolicy)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20201203035252/https://square-enix-games.com/documents/materialusagepolicy)

Accessed 3 November 2026

33 Other studios have other policies, so read the one that applies.

Vivian's field notes

34 A persona that sells content or earns from pages built on a studio's character is the case these policies forbid, and nobody has promised a tolerance to rely on.

Vivian's field notes

35 A character you do not own can leave your page the day her owner objects, and the account that carried her may go with her.

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36 She is also shared with other personas, so the look is never fully yours.

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37 If I were starting again, I would use a character of my own, even a rough one. A plain original look that I control beats a famous one that I only borrow. The look is the product, and a product on rented ground can be taken away overnight.

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38 A steady look is the hardest technical problem for a generated persona.

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40 A custom add-on model, called a LoRA, keeps a character identical in every pose, but it takes a long phase of bugs and tuning.

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41 Generated art also ages as models change, so many doms keep old-style and new-style images in separate folders.

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42 A tool that copies the pose of an existing illustration, or that fetches reference images by tag and copies their prompts, can slide into art theft once its output is posted.

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43 Nothing derived from a named artist's work should go public.

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44 Do not put a living artist's name in a prompt either, because it borrows their style, so build the look on your own recipe.

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45 A failed attempt costs the same as a good one, and clips are made in short segments and joined, so many personas post a video only now and then.

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46 A persona also runs at a loss before it earns, so budget the tools against income you have and never finance them from a sub's sends in a way that pressures him.

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48 Platforms judge the picture and not your intention, and their rules change.

Vivian's field notes

49 X allows consensual adult content that is properly labelled and not prominently displayed, and it applies this to AI-generated and animated content such as cartoons and anime.

Verified

Adult Content Policy (https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/adult-content)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261002155114/https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/adult-content)

Accessed 3 November 2026

50 X does not allow adult content in profile pictures, headers or live video.

Verified

Adult Content Policy (https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/adult-content)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261002155114/https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/adult-content)

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51 Discord bars explicit content from avatars, bios and banners, and requires an age-restricted label on channels that carry it.

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55 Mark real adult images with the sensitive media label yourself, and never try to fool a classifier.

Vivian's field notes

56 A realistic style changes which rules apply to you, as the last Patreon line shows.

Vivian's field notes

57 On honesty, X's rule on fake personas names AI-generated profile photos used to deceive others, and X does not require a real identity on a profile.

Verified

Authenticity (includes the Synthetic and Manipulated Media rules; the old manipulated-media help URL now redirects here) (https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/authenticity)

Archive (https://web.archive.org/web/20261028090009/https://help.x.com/en/rules-and-policies/authenticity)

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58 A generated face presented as a real woman does.

Vivian's field notes

59 Agree who owns and who is credited before the pictures spread.

Vivian's field notes

60 Borrowing another persona's art is fine with permission, and permission is what separates it from theft.

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61 Subs sometimes make fan art or generated images of their dom as a tribute, and some doms assign image making to a sub as a task.

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62 Otherwise it is free labour dressed as devotion.

Vivian's field notes

63 Throne says its wishlists cannot be used to exchange goods or services, including commissions.

Verified

What types of items can I add to my wishlist? (https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15808792-what-types-of-items-can-i-add-to-my-wishlist)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261019011312/https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15808792-what-types-of-items-can-i-add-to-my-wishlist)

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65 Ask what he gets back that he chose himself.

Vivian's field notes

66 Do not accept one.

Vivian's field notes

67 A fair task is thanked, and refusing it costs nothing.

Vivian's field notes

Nothing here is financial, legal or medical advice for your situation.